ANGEL GARCIA-LASCURAIN FERNANDEZ

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EDUCATION

Arizona State University 2027 (expected)
Ph.D. in Economics
Visiting Student, University of Minnesota, Fall 2026

Duke University 2022
M.S. in Economics & Computation

Universidad Iberoamericana, Mexico City 2017
B.A. in Economics

RESEARCH FIELDS

Macroeconomics, International Economics, Development Economics

WORKING PAPERS

Tariffs, Rules of Origin, and the Reorganization of North American Supply Chains
Job Market Paper
This paper quantifies how tariffs and rules of origin drive the reorganization of North American supply chains around Mexico, and what that reorganization implies for welfare. Between 2018 and 2025, three shocks reshaped this landscape: the U.S.-China trade war, the 2020 NAFTA-to-USMCA transition, and a 2025 U.S. executive order sharply raising tariffs on Mexican imports outside USMCA preference. I develop a global sourcing model in which heterogeneous firms choose source countries and, product by product, whether to export under USMCA, thus having to comply with rules of origin, and calibrate it on matched census-customs microdata. Through the lens of the model, the transition to USMCA was roughly welfare-neutral for Mexico, while the shift in relative sourcing efficiency across countries raised welfare. The higher tariffs on non-compliant goods imposed under the second Trump administration, along with a Mexican tariff on source countries outside its free-trade network, both lower welfare by raising the effective cost of choosing not to comply with USMCA.

Foreign Firm Footprints: Entry, Agglomeration and Welfare in Mexico
Foreign firms account for less than 1 % of Mexican manufacturing establishments but 40 % of employment and 60 % of exports, and they agglomerate with same-origin firms into distinct regional corridors. Using data from seven waves of the Economic Census (1994–2024), this paper develops and estimates a quantitative spatial model of foreign and domestic firm location in which origin- and industry-specific agglomeration produce this geographic dispersion. I use the results to conduct counterfactual exercises evaluating how U.S. tariff impositions would affect firm location decisions, input markets, and welfare across Mexican commuting zones. Under a 25 % tariff on Mexican exports, the income-weighted average commuting zone loses 0.051 log points of real income, and the losses are largest where foreign firms are most present.

Labor Market Power and Informality
This paper documents differences in wage markdowns in both the formal and informal sectors of the Mexican economy and proposes a theory linking labor market power to the structure of formal employment costs. The core insight is that firms with monopsony power can pass the implicit tax of formal hiring, including social security contributions, retirement funds, and firing costs, onto workers through lower wages, generating higher observed markdowns among more formal firms.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Macroeconomic Principles, Instructor Summer 2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Banco de México - General Directorate of Economic Research

Summer Researcher 2026
Economist (Analyst) 2018–2020

Sura México

Trainee, Wealth Management Division 2017

RESEARCH ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

Arizona State University, for Prof. Samuel Young 2024–

Georgetown University in Qatar, for Prof. Santiago Garcia-Couto 2023–2024

Duke University, for Prof. Matthias Kehrig 2021–2022
for Prof. Marjorie McElroy 2021–2022

TEACHING ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

Arizona State University, Development Economics Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025
for Prof. Manjira Datta

SEMINAR AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 ASU Macroeconomics Workshop; Banco de México Summer Research Program; University of Minnesota Trade Workshop; Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting

2025 ASU Macroeconomics Workshop

AWARDS

2026 ASU Dissertation Progress Award in Economics

2020 Duke Economics Masters Scholar Award

OTHER

U.S. Census Bureau: Special Sworn Status 2025–

SKILLS

Software Stata, R, Python, MATLAB, EViews, LaTeX, Microsoft Office
Languages English (Fluent), Spanish (Native)